



The new Start Menu in all its glory



You will get a handful of pre-made themes to choose from



The new and customizable Widget screen



The Windows Store with a major design overhaul

Widgets will be an AI powered feed of content that will change according to your preferences. If you swipe from the left, the feed will appear – just like Google Now works on Android and by default it'll take half of your screen. Information such as the weather, news and photos of you will be shown.

If you swipe left again, the window resizes to full screen and you can spend some more time exploring the feed. You'll also be able to resize and rearrange your widgets but you probably won't be able to pin them to your desktop like Windows 7.

Microsoft Store

The Microsoft Store is getting a major redesign, in order to blend in with the new frosted glass aesthetic that Windows 11 is going for, and there's an exciting change that we will cover later in the system changes.

SYSTEM CHANGES

Virtual Desktops

Microsoft has changed the way Virtual Desktops work in Windows 11. In Windows 10, virtual desktops were just a badly implemented feature that was essentially just a way to group open windows together, and then

switch between those groups. With Windows 11, every virtual desktop can look and feel different, and feel useful. You could have a gaming desktop that's set up to feel like you're a gamer, but also have a work desktop that looks professional when you present your entire screen to your work mates on a call. If the final version of Windows 11 allows you to lock certain apps to certain desktops, that will be icing on an already enticing looking cake. That way you can choose to only launch Netflix on the Entertainment virtual desktop, and prevent it and any notifications from it from showing up on other desktops.

Snap the Apps

Snapping apps to various parts of the screen on Windows 10 was a bit of a hit and miss affair. Sometimes, the windows themselves wouldn't resize or sometimes the windows wouldn't even snap at all! You could workaround this using Microsoft PowerTools on Windows 10, but with Windows 11 this functionality will be inbuilt. Hovering on the Maximize button will show you different layouts the current window can be snapped onto.

Better Docking

This is more of a bug fix than a feature. With Windows 10, when you connect and then disconnect an external monitor (monitor or a projector to a laptop, for instance), the windows you had opened on the external screen would pop up haphazardly on to your laptop screen. With Windows 11, they will all be automatically minimised. Even better, if you connect the external display back in, it will remember the windows and how they were docked, and display them on the external monitor.

Microsoft Teams

Microsoft has integrated Teams right into the OS, so that you can find and use it in an instant. If you use Teams of course.... Just tap the icon and it will show you your most recent conversations which include audio calls, video calls, personal and group chats. Again, like we said, this is a huge advantage to have if Teams is the service you use. It's not clear if this can integration will happen with other services.

Improved Inputs

Windows 11 is changing the way you input information into your device.